

Ruth: Providence, Redemption, and a Kinsman-Redeemer

In the days when everyone did what was right in their own eyes, God was quietly writing a redemption.

Text. Ruth 1 to 4

Good for. People walking through loss who cannot see God working

The arc. Ruth tells of an empty widow brought to fullness through loyalty, providence, and a redeemer who pays what she cannot. The thread is the hidden hand of God turning an ordinary harvest into the line of the King.

1. Empty Handed

Ruth 1:1-22

Big idea. Naomi returns from Moab bitter and bereaved, and Ruth clings to her with a loyalty that binds herself to Naomi's God.

Aim. To sit with the hearer in loss before rushing them toward resolution.

Notes

2. Under His Wings

Ruth 2:1-23

Big idea. Ruth happens upon the field of Boaz, and the narrator's quiet word reveals there is no chance in a world God governs.

Aim. To help the hearer read the ordinary providences of their own days.

Notes

3. Spread Your Wings Over Me

Ruth 3:1-18

Big idea. Ruth asks Boaz to be her redeemer, and he commits himself to do everything required to bring her in.

Aim. To show the hearer the boldness of faith that throws itself on a redeemer's kindness.

Notes

4. A Redeemer and a King

Ruth 4:1-22

Big idea. Boaz pays the price, redeems the family, and the empty widow holds a child whose line runs to David and beyond.

Aim. To lift the hearer from one family's rescue to the Redeemer the whole story points toward.

Notes

HOW TO USE THIS SERIES

These are starting points, not scripts. Each series gives you the arc, the divisions, and a working aim for every sermon, but the breakdown here is scaffolding you will take down once the text has done its own work in you. Read the whole book before you preach the first week of it. Let the passage divisions teach you where the seams actually are.

The text sets the agenda. Not the felt needs you arrived with, not the outline that looks clean on a slide, not the application you already know you want to land. Sit under the passage long enough for it to surprise you, and then preach what it says rather than what you planned. A big idea you did not have to fight for is usually one the text did not give you.